

# "They Write / I Write": The Gatherings That Matter. An Online Academic Writing Course for Undergraduates

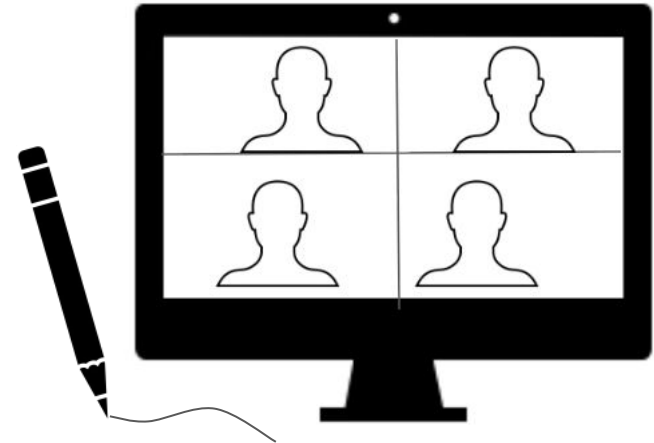
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**IOWA**

## Overview

- Product: Online College Writing Course
- LMS site: ICON
- Delivery format: Asynchronous
- For whom: Undergraduates
- Key feature: **"They Write / I Write"**



# Needs Analysis

## Problem

Emotional struggles (Stritch, 2025)

In-video dropout (Kim et al., 2013)

Test anxiety (Ramirez & Beilock, 2011)

ESL learners' struggle (Dunn, 2021)



## Solution

Online study rooms

Segmenting Principle (Mayer, 2009)

Low-stakes quizzes (Roediger et al., 2011)

Online resources for writing

# Key Design Decisions

## 1. Online study rooms

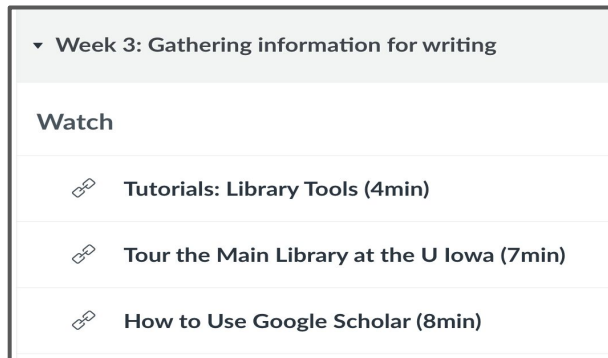
→ "They Write / I Write"



## Community building

(Alonso et al., 2005; Stritch, 2025).

## 2. Segmenting Principle



## 3. Low-stakes quizzes

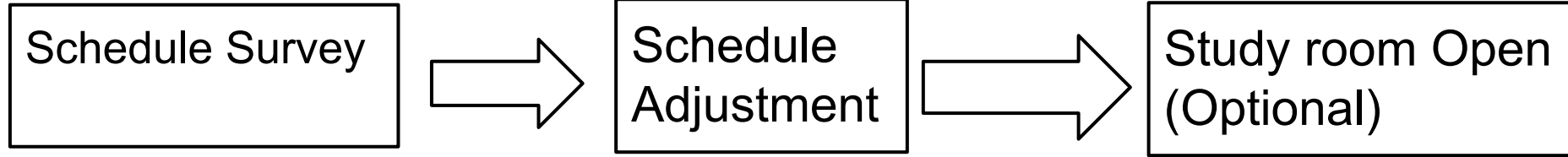
- Aim: Retrieval Practice
- **Test as a learning tool**  
(Rodieger et al., 2011)

## 4. Online resources for writing

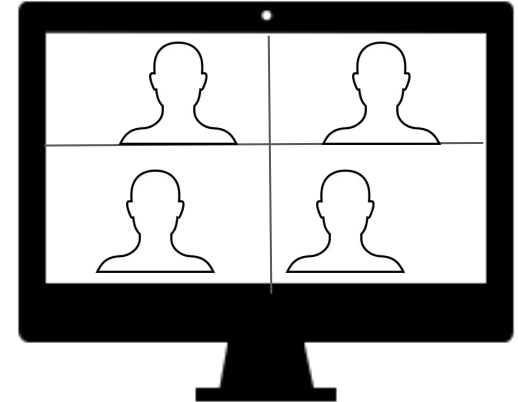
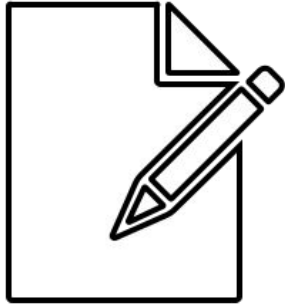
- The Academic Collocation List
- Academic Phrasebank
- Writing Center at U Iowa

# 1. Online study rooms (Weekly/Exam weeks)

→ "They Write / I Write"

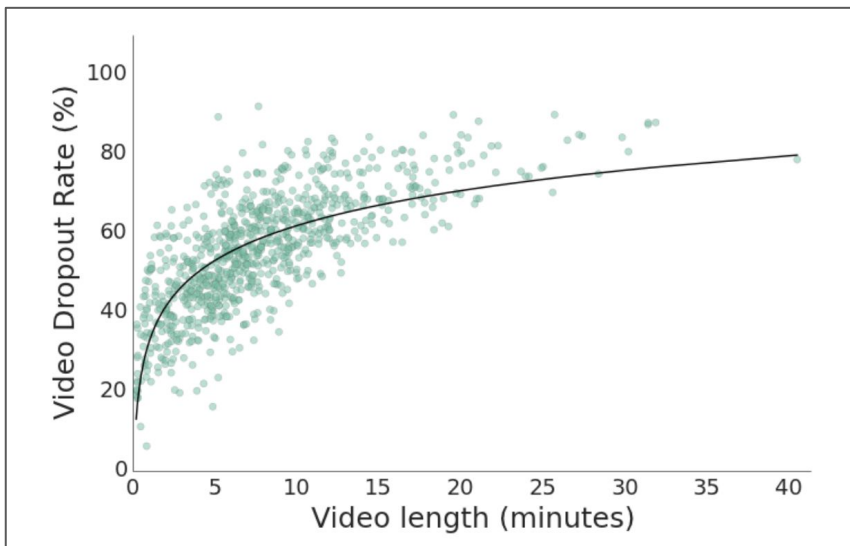


Week 1 for weekly rooms  
Week 7&12 for exam weeks



## 2. Segmenting Principle

Longer videos → higher dropout



(Kim et al., 2013, p33)

Applying Mayer (2009)'s principle

▼ Week 3: Gathering information for writing

Watch



Tutorials: Library Tools (4min)

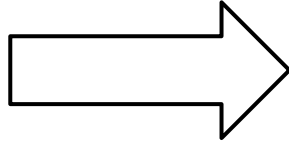
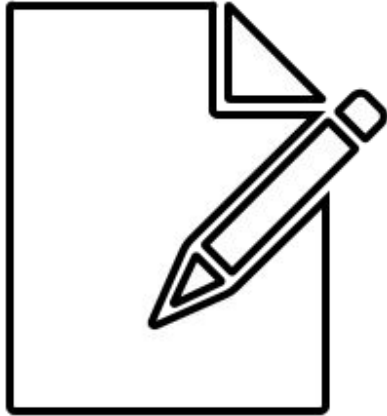


Tour the Main Library at the U Iowa (7min)



How to Use Google Scholar (8min)

### 3. Low-stakes quizzes



Test anxiety

>

Question 1

1 pts

In academic writing, since the most important point is your claim, you should give reasons only from your own experiences, observations, and opinions.

☐ True

☐ False

>

Question 2

1 pts

In academic writing, writers are expected to use academic and formal vocabulary instead of slangs and colloquialism.

☐ True

☐ False

- Aim: Retrieval Practice
- **Test as a learning tool**  
(Rodieger et al., 2011)

# 4. Online resources for writing

## Academic Collocation List

| # | Component I + (Part of Speech)<br>Component II + (Part of Speech)                             |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | abstract (adj)<br>concept (n)                                                                 |
| 2 | academic (adj)<br>achievement (n)<br>career (n)<br>circles (n)<br>community (n)<br>debate (n) |

|    |                                                    |
|----|----------------------------------------------------|
| 29 | achieve (a) (v)<br>goal (n)                        |
| 30 | achieve (an) (v)<br>objective (n)<br>outcome (n)   |
| 32 | acquire (v)<br>knowledge (n)                       |
| 33 | active (adj)<br>involvement (n)<br>participant (n) |

## Academic Phrasebank

— Devices that distance the author from a proposition

It is thought that ...

It is believed that ...

It has been reported that ...

It is a widely held view that ...

It has commonly been assumed that ...

## Writing Center at U Iowa

- Make an appointment
- Weekly meetings
- Document review

## UI Library resources

[CLICK HERE TO CONTACT A LIBRARIAN](#) →

### Resources

|                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Contact a Librarian   | Guides                            | Databases             |
| My Library            | Libraries Locations               | Find Media            |
| Course Reserves       | Special Collections and Archives  | Iowa Digital Library  |
| Iowa Research Online  | E-Journals                        | WorldCat              |

# Course Overview 1

| Week | Content                              |
|------|--------------------------------------|
| 1    | Introduction to College Writing      |
| 2    | Audience & Planning for writing      |
| 3    | Gathering information for writing    |
| 4    | Reading for writing                  |
| 5    | The importance of argument           |
| 6    | Paragraph writing as a thinking tool |
| 7    | Paragraph analysis                   |



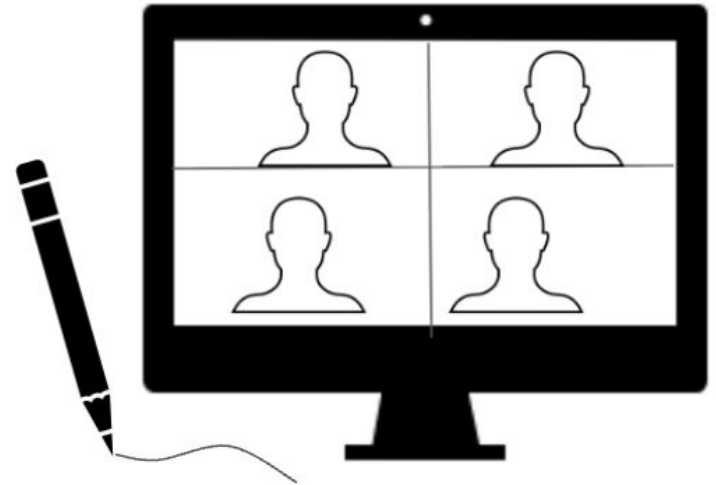
# Course Overview 2

| Week  | Content                                     |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|
| 8     | Writing a conclusion                        |
| 9     | No class (Midterm paper due)                |
| 10    | Writing as Collaboration                    |
| 11    | Ethical use of AI in writing                |
| 12    | AI as a supporting tool in writing          |
| 13    | Understand the standard of your major field |
| 14-15 | Final Paper + Collaborative Writing task    |

# Educational Implication

## "They Write / I Write"

- Alleviating emotional struggles in writing
- Community building
- Developing an identity as an independent but collaborative writer



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